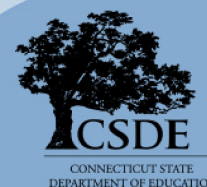


DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2020–21



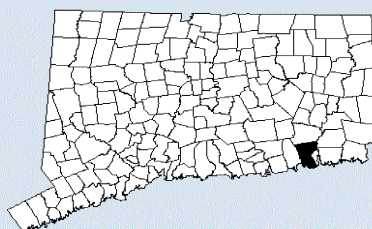
Waterford School District

Mr. Thomas Giard III, Superintendent • 860-444-5801 • www.waterfordschools.org

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	10
Enrollment	2,367
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$19,458
Total Expenditures ¹	\$51,681,711

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2019-20 school year.



Community Information

[AdvanceCT Town Profiles](#) provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities

Contents

Students.....	1
Educators.....	2
Instruction and Resources.....	2
Performance and Accountability.....	4
Narratives.....	7

Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2020-21 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality, or to ensure that statistics based on a very small sample size are not interpreted as equally representative as those based on a sufficiently larger sample size.

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2020 Enrollment²

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
Female	1,174	49.6	48.4
Male	1,193	50.4	51.5
American Indian or Alaska Native	6	0.3	0.3
Asian	115	4.9	5.2
Black or African American	73	3.1	12.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	269	11.4	27.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	7	0.3	0.1
Two or More Races	127	5.4	4.0
White	1,770	74.8	49.9
English Learners	64	2.7	8.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	648	27.4	42.7
Students with Disabilities ³	394	16.6	16.3

NOTE: To protect student privacy, gender counts are suppressed (*) when fewer than 6 students enrolled in the district identify as non-binary.

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	130	11.4	7	0.6
Male	149	12.7	13	1.1
Black or African American	16	24.2	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	60	22.7	*	*
White	170	9.8	11	0.6
English Learners	20	27.4	0	0.0
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	159	23.6	13	1.8
Students with Disabilities	77	20.9	11	2.5
District	279	12.1	20	0.8
State		19.0		1.4

Number of students in 2019-20 qualified as truant under state statute: 0

Number of school-based arrests: Fewer than 6

NOTE: In the 2020-21 school year, students attended school in-person to varying degrees; some learned fully/mostly remotely for the entire school year. Chronic absenteeism calculations are based only on in-person school days.

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Waterford School District

Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	172.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	7.0
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	30.4
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	82.0
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	4.5
School Level	10.8
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	1.0
Support Staff	5.0
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	11.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	16.8
School Nurses	5.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	94.7

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	0	0.0	0.1
Asian	2	0.8	1.3
Black or African American	2	0.8	4.1
Hispanic or Latino of any race	5	2.0	4.3
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	0	0.0	0.1
White	240	96.4	89.9

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2019-20

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	8.0	7.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*	8	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	20	74.1	22	81.5
White	126	88.1	154	88.0
English Learners	*	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	32	78.0	50	86.2
Students with Disabilities	23	76.7	32	68.1
District	164	85.0	200	87.0
State		75.9		85.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual enrollment courses.

Students with Disabilities Who Spend 79.1 to 100 Percent of Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	40	74.1
Emotional Disturbance	8	28.6
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	139	97.2
Other Health Impairment	58	76.3
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	27	96.4
District	282	77.0
State		67.9

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Waterford School District

Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	57	2.3	2.1
Emotional Disturbance	28	1.1	1.1
Intellectual Disability	16	0.7	0.5
Learning Disability	143	5.9	5.8
Other Health Impairment	76	3.1	3.3
Other Disabilities	29	1.2	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	33	1.4	1.9
All Disabilities	382	15.7	15.9

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	18	4.7	8.3
Private Schools or Other Settings	20	5.2	4.8

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2019-20

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$32,940,523	\$12,402	\$11,205
Support services - students	\$3,466,301	\$1,417	\$1,346
Support services - instruction	\$2,492,207	\$1,019	\$698
Support services - general administration	\$2,131,142	\$871	\$464
Support services - school based administration	\$2,126,582	\$869	\$1,037
Central and other support services	\$759,569	\$311	\$691
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$4,533,611	\$1,853	\$1,692
Student transportation services	\$2,427,326	\$992	\$1,159
Food services	\$52,165	\$21	\$21
Enterprise operations	\$752,286	\$308	\$151
Total	\$51,681,711	\$19,458	\$17,838

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2019-20

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$5,102,161	38.2	29.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$1,823,530	13.7	11.1
Other Salaries	\$308,367	2.3	9.5
Employee Benefits	\$2,134,950	16.0	13.5
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$621,741	4.7	5.4
Special Education Tuition	\$2,563,454	19.2	22.5
Supplies	\$19,993	0.1	0.5
Property Services	\$9,525	0.1	0.3
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$709,109	5.3	7.2
Equipment	\$5,180	0.0	0.2
All Other Expenditures	\$52,388	0.4	0.1
Total	\$13,350,398	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		25.8	25.1

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2019-20

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	96.1
State	1.8
Federal	1.9
Tuition & Other	0.2

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Waterford School District

Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

READING	NAEP 2019		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	40	41	50
National Public	34	32	36
MATH	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
Connecticut	45	39	32
National Public	40	33	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2019.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no table is shown here. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Waterford School District

Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2019-20	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	27	92.6
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	67	80.6
Students with Disabilities	52	63.5
District	222	86.9
State		88.8

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2019-20 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Meeting Benchmark on at Least One College Readiness Exam³

	Participation ⁴	Meeting Benchmark	
	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	81.0	91	44.4
Male	69.7	77	35.3
Black or African American	*	*	*
Hispanic or Latino	75.9	19	35.2
White	74.5	127	39.9
English Learners	*	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	61.6	19	19.2
Students with Disabilities	48.1	*	*
District	75.2	168	39.7
State	85.0		36.0

³College readiness exams and benchmark scores are as follows:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam

⁴Participation Rate equals the number of test-takers in 11th and 12th grade divided by the number of students enrolled in those grades, as a percentage.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

Copyright © 2021 ACT, Inc. www.act.org

IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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* The data are suppressed to ensure confidentiality.

College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2020	Class of 2019
	Entrance ³	Persistence ⁴
	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Female	79.4	93.7
Male	64.3	84.7
Black or African American	*	*
Hispanic or Latino of any race	68.0	*
White	70.3	90.5
English Learners	*	*
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	57.1	75.9
Students with Disabilities	42.4	71.4
District	71.4	89.4
State	67.4	84.9

³ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁴ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Waterford School District

Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, a modified table is shown below. All indicators that were not calculated for the 2020-21 school year (including overall Accountability Index) have been excluded and columns that referenced points have also been removed to avoid confusion. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	State Average Index/Rate
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	12.1%	<=5%	19.0%
	High Needs Students	21.5%	<=5%	30.2%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	86.1%	75%	80.6%
	% Passing Exams	39.7%	75%	36.0%
On-track to High School Graduation		91.5%	94%	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2020 Cohort)		86.9%	94%	88.8%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2018 Cohort)		83.8%	94%	85.2%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2020)		71.4%	75%	67.4%
Arts Access		52.2%	60%	50.7%

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	83.8%	10.2%	9.8%	Y

¹ If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

² If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

NOTE: As a result of ongoing challenges related to the novel Coronavirus Disease 2019 (COVID-19), Connecticut's request for a waiver from implementing district/school accountability for the 2020-21 school year was approved. Therefore, no SIMR data are available. For additional information, please view Connecticut's waiver response at: <https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Digest/2020-21/CommissionerMemoAccountabilityWaiver.pdf>

Supporting Resources:

Two-page FAQ at http://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/nextgenFAQ_revisedDec2018.pdf

Detailed Presentation at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Next%20Generation%20Accountability%20System_Detailed%20Presentation_Jan_2020.pdf

Using Accountability Results to Guide Improvement at https://edsight.ct.gov/relatedreports/Using_Accountability_Results_to_Guide_Improvement.pdf

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Waterford School District

Narratives

School District Improvement Plans and Parental Outreach Activities

Waterford is in its fourth year of Strategic Coherence Plan, school growth plans for each school with goals on academics and social-emotional learning. We continue to execute the Professional Learning Community (PLC) program with our staff. The PLC program requires that staff work in grade level or subject area teams to discuss and analyze student data from common district or State assessments.

There is a Professional Learning and Evaluation Committee comprised of teachers that helps refine our evaluation plan and assists in setting the direction of professional learning.

Curriculum Leaders, Department Chairs, and Instructional Coaches in Literacy, Numeracy and Technology continue to work with their groups on common goals and instructional strategies centered on implementing the Common Core State Standards. By meeting regularly, these groups have an opportunity to discuss what works or what doesn't and improve upon it.

The district has made an effort to assist those students who are not identified as special education, but are also not at the proficient level. We have Literacy and Mathematics Support Teachers in each of our elementary schools and our middle school that focus on reading and math. Waterford High School offers support classes in reading, mathematics and writing for those students that need assistance.

Special Education services are delivered through cooperatively taught classes as well as some self-contained skill based classes at Waterford High School and Clark Lane Middle School. Waterford High School works collaboratively with Clark Lane Middle School to develop transition plans for students with special needs. Our elementary schools continue to provide integrated Special Education services, with a focus on the provision of related services in the general education settings as well. We offer Explorers programs at each level which provide individualized programming for students with highly specialized needs. Our Special Education staff has focused on reading and literacy, with an emphasis on training in research-based programs which include Wilson Language, Orton-Gillingham, Read Naturally and the EdMark Reading Program. Parental outreach has grown in our district. Each school has specific social media handles for their schools so parents are able to see day by day what is happening at each school. Our district website lists all community and school activities, and ways for parents to become involved. We also host a Parent Advisory Council each month at the Board of Education and invite parents from all five schools to participate and give feedback about areas of strength and opportunity at their child's school.

Additionally, on the district level, we have developed a new user friendly website and launched a new mobile app. Also, a new district calendar that collates events from across the district into one calendar has been created. The district is continually looking for ways to engage families in the most meaningful ways possible with their children's learning. At the school level, several programs were established. At Clark Lane, parents attended French and Spanish Honors Society night where students were honored for their efforts in World Language learning. At the elementary schools, there were many online parent opportunities engaging parents into the instruction that is going on in the classroom and online.

Efforts to Reduce Racial, Ethnic and Economic Isolation

The district has taken on equity as a significant initiative in the 2020-2021 school year. Administrators were provided training through CREC; The district formed a committee which met 4 times and guided much of the March PD day; Schools formed a team at each school; WHS's advisory program underwent enhancements that enabled staff to be more comfortable having conversations with students on this topic.

As a District: -Administrator Team trained on Anti-Racism. -Superintendent part of LEARN Group with Lee Teitel. -District Equity Team Formed and Functioning. -Launched School Equity Teams. -BOE Member Training on Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion. -Districtwide Initial Professional Development to all staff. -Began Process for Curriculum Equity "Audit".

In keeping in alignment with the 2020-2021 board goal, "Advocate for and build a district that promotes equity", the district implemented the following: -Launch of our District Equity Understanding and Action Team made up of administration, teachers, non-certified personnel, board representation, and community representatives. This team focused on: -Planning and implementing staff training on equity during the 2020-2021 school year. -Student programming. -Equity implications for our curriculum. -Launch of school-based Equity Action Teams to further this work at the school level. -Districtwide staff training in the 2020-2021 school year a series of workshops on affirming difference, cultural competence and achievement, using critical consciousness to challenge inequity, and working against racial bias. -Student equity programming embedded in the WHS advisory program. -WPS Administrator Team participated in year-long Anti-Racism Educator Framework Training. -Superintendent Equity Training on leading a district through discussions on race, racism, and equity with Lee Teitel of Harvard University.

Waterford offers our students the opportunity to attend various high schools in the region. Transportation is provided to the following schools, the Agricultural Science and Technology program at Ledyard High School, Grasso Technical High School and Norwich Regional Technical High School. The quality of programs that Waterford has created over the years has greatly improved.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2020-21

Waterford School District

Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

It is the policy of the Board of Education and the practice of the school system that resources are allocated equally among all schools. Each elementary school teaches the same curriculum and uses the same adopted texts and resources. Each school budget is developed through a formula based on the number of classes and students in the school.

Technology resources are distributed equally among the schools in the district according to a technology plan approved by the State of Connecticut. Each of our elementary schools has been designed the same, with each school having the same number of interactive whiteboards, computers, and computer labs. The elementary schools have just about equal populations due to Waterford's redistricting from five to three elementary schools, which was done to achieve more equity across the schools.

Each principal oversees the distribution of resources in their school. The Director of Finance & Operations and the Assistant Superintendent also look at each school and the district as a whole to ensure resources are allocated equally. Class sizes are monitored and adjusted at the district level, ensuring equality across grades and schools.